

Bram Marchetti

Chronicle, volume 3

Blunt, practical and allergic to small talk hydroponics technician of the Academy of Vell

Volume 5 of 10 in the Bram Marchetti collection. The other volumes cover the rest of this character's record.

About this volume

Day-to-day records kept by Bram, hydroponics technician of the Academy of Vell, in no particular order of importance. Among the things Bram keeps at the Hall of Echoes is a oilskin map; Bram calls it 'The Verdict' and will not explain why. It appears in these pages more often than it deserves.

<i>Full name</i>	Bram Marchetti
<i>Volume</i>	Chronicle 3
<i>Name of the oilskin map</i>	The Verdict

Entries

Entry 1, autumn of year 22

the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the quarantine. Bram read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Bram closed early, walked to the candle library, and watched the lights come on. Bram won 83 guilders on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on supper. The weather turned. Bram moved the signal flag indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. Bram polished 'The Verdict', the oilskin map, and said nothing about it.

Entry 2, spring of year 22

The weather turned. Bram moved the hand bell indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the comet. Bram was hired to carry a signal flag from the greenhouse cloisters to the north observatory without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Bram closed early, walked to the north observatory, and watched the lights come on. Bram repaired the cracked compass at the greenhouse cloisters for Vesna, who paid in 10 guilders and a long story about the census. Bram spent the day counting stock at the greenhouse cloisters: 37 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short.

Entry 3, winter of year 22

At the north observatory, Bram taught a newcomer how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Nadira came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Bram said nothing useful and made tea instead. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the comet flared up between Bram and a neighbour outside the north observatory; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Bram for the password to the workshop. Bram laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.